Case study · Axel Pettersson · November 2026 · public SCB data, analysed in SQL (DuckDB)

Swedish consumer borrowers are still paying for rates that have already fallen

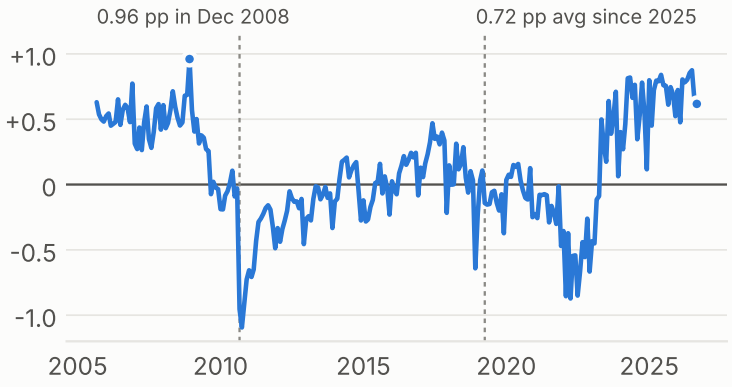
If you have an existing consumer loan in Sweden today, you pay on average about 0.7 percentage points more than someone taking out a new one. This summer the gap reached its widest level since the 2008 rate cuts. That gap is the pool of savings a refinancing offer competes for.

0.72 pp
avg. gap between existing and new consumer loan rates, Jan 2025–Sep 2026

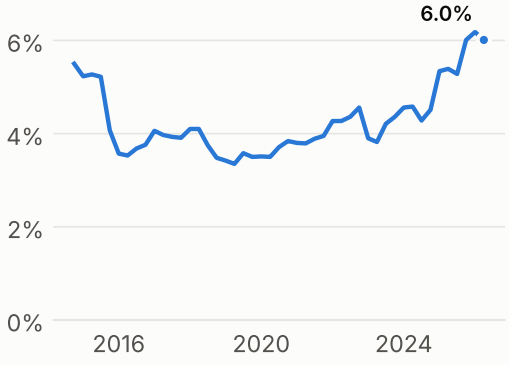
≈ 2.2 bn SEK
a year existing borrowers pay above today's new-loan rates (rough: gap × 311 bn SEK stock)

6.0%
of consumer loans non-performing, up from 3.5% in Q4 2019 (mortgages: 0.23%)

Existing minus new consumer loan rate
percentage points, monthly, Sep 2005–Sep 2026 · dashed lines: likely reporting breaks



Non-performing consumer loans
share of outstanding, quarterly, Q4 2014–Q2 2026



What I found

- **Old loans lag when rates fall.** Since the peak in December 2023, rates on new consumer loans are down 2.0 pp, but rates on existing ones only 1.4 pp. The same pattern showed up in the 2008 cuts, so it looks like a feature of rate-cutting cycles, not a one-off.
- **The opportunity is real but uneven.** A gap of 0.72 pp on 311 bn SEK is roughly 2.2 bn SEK a year. Some of that is unreachable: it's an average, and many borrowers won't qualify or won't bother.
- **Risk is rising at the same time.** Non-performing consumer loans are at 6.0%, close to the series high of 6.2% the quarter before. The borrowers who would save most may also be the hardest to approve.

Where the data could be misleading me

- **Series breaks.** New consumer rates jump about 2 pp in a single month in Sep 2010 and Apr 2019 while mortgage rates don't move. That looks like a reporting change, so I don't compare levels across those dates.
- **Mix, not price.** "New" includes renegotiated loans. A lower average can mean safer borrowers are borrowing, not that anyone got a cheaper deal.
- **Averages hide the tail.** The interesting customers sit far above the average rate. Aggregate data can't show how many there are.

What I'd test with a lender's own data

Does acceptance of a refinancing offer rise with the size of the saving, and where does it flatten? And does showing the saving in kronor beat showing it as a rate? Both are clean A/B tests on an offer screen.

Sources: SCB Finansmarknadsstatistik, tables RantaT03N (lending rates by purpose, households, MFI) and FM5001Nodlidande (loans and non-performing loans). Gap = rate on outstanding consumer loans minus rate on new and renegotiated ones.

SQL: analysis.sql · axelpettersson99.github.io